APP STORE / USER GUIDE

How to Use App Store Promo Codes

English edition iPhone iPad Mac



Use this guide to redeem an app download promo code from a developer and get the specified app for free. Redeem the code before downloading the app.

This guide covers app download promo codes. For in-app purchase or subscription offer codes, follow the provider's offer terms.

Before you begin

Have an unused code and an internet connection ready. Sign in to the App Store with the Apple Account you want to use for the app. Check that your device and software meet the app's requirements.

Redeem on iPhone or iPad

01 Open the App Store

Use the iPhone or iPad on which you want to use the app.

02 Open your account

Tap your photo, initials, or account icon. Sign in to your Apple Account if prompted.

03 Find the redemption option

Tap Redeem Code. Older software may show Redeem Gift Card or Code. [2]

04 Enter your promo code

Choose Enter Code Manually. Paste the complete code and remove any extra spaces at the beginning or end.

05 Confirm redemption

Tap Redeem. Complete any account verification and check for a success message.

06 Download and open the app

Follow the prompts to download. If needed, open your account, choose Apps & Purchase History, then Your Apps. Find the app and tap the cloud download icon. [3]

Redeem a macOS app on Mac

Open the App Store, click your name in the sidebar, and sign in. Click Redeem Code, choose manual entry, paste the code, and follow the prompts to redeem and download. [2]

Promo codes for multi-platform or Apple TV apps must be redeemed on an iPhone or iPad. [1]

SUPPORT / APP STORE

Redemption Help and Code Rules

Code rules

- Each app promo code can be used once and expires four weeks after it was generated, not four weeks after you received it. [1]
- The code can be redeemed in an App Store country or region where the app is available. [1]
- An app obtained with a promo code can receive updates, but cannot be rated or reviewed on the App Store. [1]

Common problems

The code is invalid

Copy the full code again and remove extra spaces. Ask the provider to confirm that it is a valid download promo code for the intended app.

The code has already been redeemed

If you used it before, sign in with the same Apple Account and download the app from your app list. Otherwise, contact the provider. [3]

The code has expired

Ask the provider for a new code.

The app still shows a price or is missing

Check the Apple Account and redemption result, then look in your account's app list. Resolve the issue before tapping the price button to pay. [3]

The app is unavailable or will not download

Check availability in your account's country or region, device compatibility, internet access, and free storage. Send a screenshot of the error to the code provider if needed.

When asking for help, include the app name, device model, software version, and error message. Share an unused code privately with its provider rather than posting it publicly.

Official Apple references

[1] App promo code rules and expiration

[2] App Store redemption controls

[3] Redownload apps

Reference [2] describes gift cards; this guide uses its App Store redemption controls only. App promo code rules are covered by [1].

Button names may vary by software version and language.